

4. Mowgli Joins the Wolf Pack

Rudyard Kipling



Importance of family

Warm-up

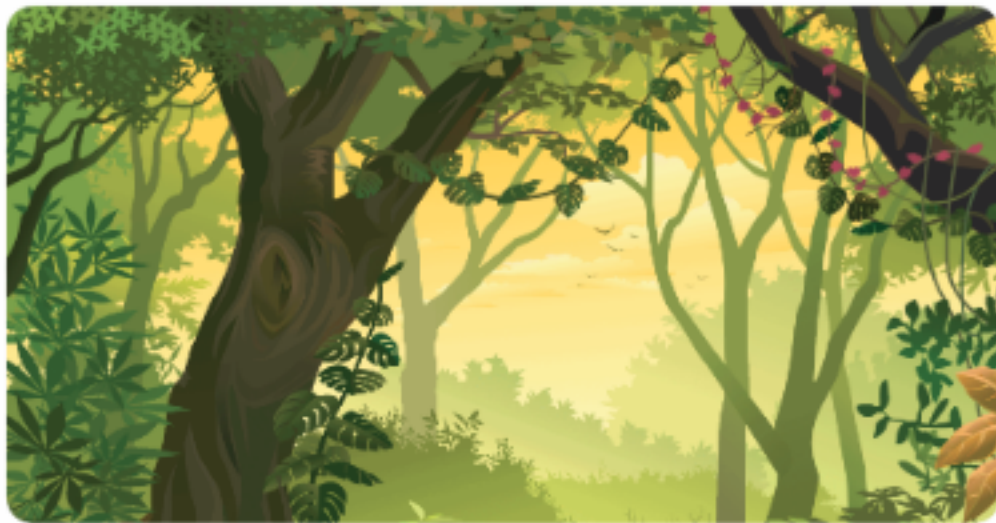
The law is a system of rules that everyone in a society or country must obey. 21 IL

- A. Write down any three rules that you obey at home, in school and in a playground. Are there any common ones? CT



The system of rules that animals are said to follow in a jungle is called the Law of the Jungle. 21 IL

- B. Write down three jungle laws. How different are they from the ones that you wrote earlier? CT





This extract is taken from Rudyard Kipling's The Jungle Book which is a collection of stories about wild animals and their interaction with human beings. Among them, few of the stories are about Mowgli, a little boy who was brought up by a family of wolves.



It was a very warm evening in the Seeonee hills. Father Wolf woke up from his day's rest. Mother Wolf lay with her cubs. "It is time to hunt again," said Father Wolf. He was going to spring downhill when Tabaqui, the jackal, came and said, "Shere Khan has shifted his hunting grounds. He has told me that he will hunt among these hills for the next moon."

Shere Khan was the tiger who lived near the Waingunga River, twenty miles away.

"He has no right!" Father Wolf began angrily—"By the Law of the Jungle he has no right to change his quarters without due warning."

"He has been lame in one foot from his birth. That is why he has only killed cattle. Now the villagers of the Waingunga are angry with him, and he has come here to make our villagers angry. This is very dangerous for us," Mother Wolf said.

cubs

the young ones of a wolf, tiger or lion

next moon

for approximately one month





"I must go now," said Tabaqui quietly. "You can hear Shere Khan below in the woods."

Father Wolf listened, and below in the valley he heard the whine of a tiger who had caught nothing.

"He wants to hunt Man," said Mother Wolf.

"Man!" said Father Wolf, showing all his white teeth. "Are there not enough beetles and frogs in the tanks that he must eat Man? And on our ground too!"

The Law of the Jungle, which never orders anything without a reason, forbids every beast to eat Man. The real reason for this is that mankilling means, sooner or later, the arrival of men on elephants, with guns, and hundreds of men with gongs, rockets and torches. Then everybody in the jungle suffers.

"Something is coming uphill," said Mother Wolf, twitching one ear. "Get ready."

The bushes rustled a little in the thicket, and Father Wolf dropped with his haunches under him, ready for his leap. Then, the wolf checked in mid-spring. The result was that he shot up straight into the air for four or five feet, landing almost where he left ground.

"Man!" he snapped. "A man's cub. Look!"

Directly in front of him, holding on by a low branch, stood a naked baby who could just walk. He looked up into Father Wolf's face, and laughed.

"Is that a man's cub?" said Mother Wolf. "I have never seen one. Bring it here."

checked

(here) stopped

naked

not wearing any clothes





T Father Wolf's jaws closed right on the child's back and not even a tooth scratched the skin as he laid it down among the cubs.

"How little! How naked, and—how bold!" said Mother Wolf softly. The baby was pushing his way between the cubs to get close to the warm hide.

The moonlight was blocked out of the mouth of the cave, for Shere Khan's great square head and shoulders were thrust into the entrance. Tabaqui, behind him, was squeaking: "My lord, my lord, it went in here!"

"Shere Khan does us great honour," said Father Wolf, but his eyes were very angry. "What does Shere Khan need?"

"My prey. A man's cub went this way," said Shere Khan. "Its parents have run off. Give it to me."

Father Wolf knew that the mouth of the cave was too narrow for a tiger to come in. "The Wolves are free people," said Father Wolf. "They take orders from



the Head of the Pack, and not from any striped cattle-killer. The man's cub is ours—to kill if we choose."

"No, the child is mine. It is I, Shere Khan, who speaks!" said the tiger.

The tiger's roar filled the cave with thunder. Mother Wolf shook herself clear of the cubs and sprang forward, her eyes, like two green moons in the darkness, facing the blazing eyes of Shere Khan.

"And it is I, Mother Wolf, who answers. The man's cub is mine, Shere Khan—mine! He shall not be killed. He shall live to run with the Pack and to hunt with the Pack; and in the end, he shall hunt you! Now go. Go!"

The Law of the Jungle is very clear. All cubs must be taken to the Council Rock at the time of the full moon. The other wolves then see the new cubs and learn to recognise them.

recognise

know who somebody is or what something is when you see or hear them



   After that, the Pack looks after them and nobody is allowed to harm them.

When the time came, Father Wolf took Mowgli to the Council Rock. The child sat and played happily with some stones in the moonlight. Shere Khan demanded that the child be given to him, but Akela, the leader of the wolves, answered, "We are the Free People. Why should we listen to anyone else?"

Some of the other young wolves said, "Give him to Shere Khan. Why should we make the tiger angry?"

But Baloo, the brown bear, who taught all the wolf cubs, said, "Let him stay with the Wolf Pack. I will teach him myself."

Bagheera, the Black Panther, jumped into the circle of wolves.

"Let the Man-cub live and run with you," he said.

And so, it was decided. Mowgli, the Man-cub, became one of the Wolf Pack of the Seonee Hills.

demanded

asked firmly



Reading

(reading for main ideas)

 **A. Work in pairs and tick (✓) the right options to answer these questions.**  

1. Why did Father Wolf say that he must set off soon?
 - a. He needed to go for a Council meeting.
 - b. He had to go hunting.
 - c. He had to find Shere Khan.
 - d. He had to find the Man-cub.
2. What information did Tabaqui give Father Wolf and Mother Wolf?
 - a. that Shere Khan was going to hunt on their hills
 - b. that Shere Khan had been chased out by the villagers
 - c. that a Man-cub had been spotted on their hill
 - d. that Akela was calling for a Council meeting

3. When are all cubs taken to the Council Rock?
- at the time of the new moon
 - every evening
 - at the time of the full moon
 - at sunset

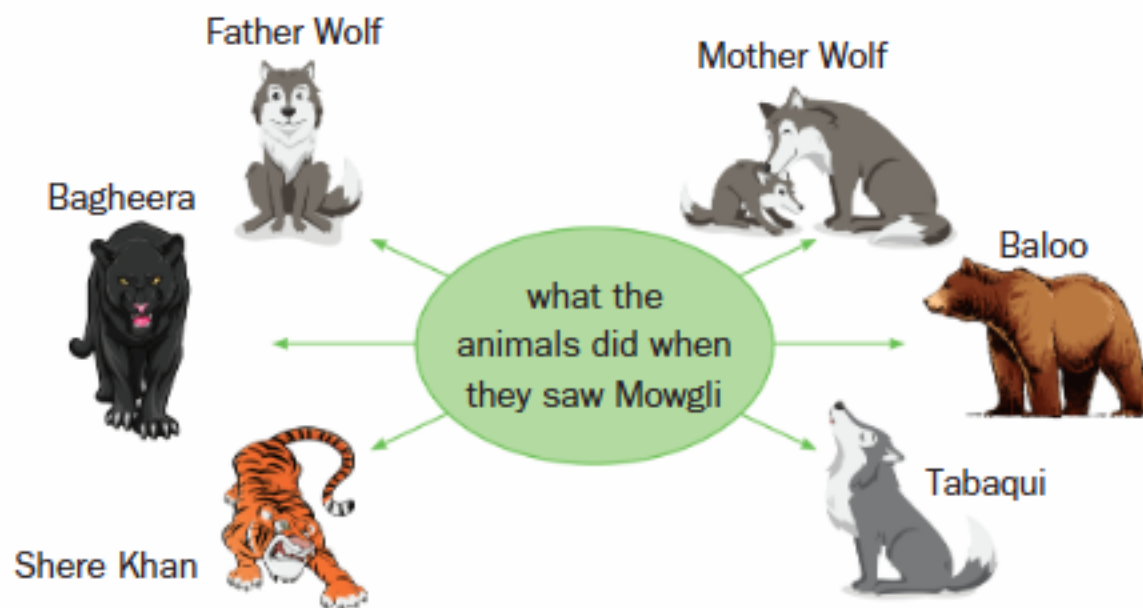
B. Answer these questions. Check your answers.



- What was the Law of the Jungle?
- Describe the Man-cub.

C. Say how each of these animals responded on seeing the Man-cub.

Check with your teacher for correct answers.



D. Think and answer.



(reading for inference; HOTS)

- Why had Shere Khan decided to change his hunting grounds?
- Why do you think the Wolf Pack decided to keep Mowgli?

E. Discuss in class.



co-existing in nature



- Why do you think animals attack human beings—is it out of habit or to protect themselves?
- Some human beings harm wild animals. Why do they do so? What can we do to stop such incidents?





Using Grammar

(the simple present tense)

i We use the **simple present tense** to express routine actions.

- The jackal **roams** around the cave of the wolves in the evenings.
- Mowgli **plays** with Baloo and Bagheera every morning.



A. Complete these sentences with suitable verbs in the simple present tense. Discuss your answers with your teacher.



1. My parents _____ juice every morning.
2. I _____ to read a book during weekends.
3. Every evening, I _____ with my friends.
4. My mother _____ me for piano classes in the evenings.
5. The principal _____ to the students every day during the morning assembly.



(the simple past tense)

ii To express actions that have already happened, we use the **simple past tense**.

Father Wolf **took** Mowgli to the Council Rock.

B. Complete these sentences with the simple past tense of the verbs in the brackets.

Discuss your answers with your teacher.



1. Mother Wolf _____ (refuse) to give the Man-cub to Shere Khan.
2. Father Wolf _____ (take) Mowgli to Akela to decide whether he should keep him or give him away.
3. The Wolf Pack happily _____ (accept) Mowgli.
4. The animals _____ (teach) Mowgli.
5. He _____ (play) in the jungle with his friends.





Using Words

(compound nouns)

Look at these nouns. They are made of two words.

- moonlight = moon + light
- cattle-killer = cattle + killer

Such nouns are called **compound nouns**.



- A. Work in pairs and combine the words in column A with those in column B to make compound nouns. Use each word only once. Then, each of you make sentences with the new words. Check each other's sentences.**



A

B

1. fire
2. note
3. key
4. foot
5. hair

- a. book
- b. ball
- c. cut
- d. fly
- e. board



(collocations with adjectives and nouns)

Some adjectives and nouns combine naturally and form common expressions.

Look at these examples from the story.

- wild animal
- full moon



- B. Complete these sentences by choosing the right words from the brackets. Discuss your answers with your teacher. There are several such collocations that we use while communicating. Find more such interesting collocations from the Internet.**



1. It was a (big/deep) mistake to go out in the rain.
2. We had (great/huge) fun at the circus.
3. Janet likes to wear (bright/shiny) colours.
4. They were late because they were stuck in (heavy/long) traffic.
5. Everyone agreed that ice cream was a (good/happy) idea.





Dictionary Work

(alphabetical order)

Arrange these words in alphabetical order. Carry your own pocket dictionary to class and look up the meanings.

flask, taste, trip, health, house, bridge, beast, sketch, stone, drip



Assessment of Speaking and Listening



Listening

(connecting aural and visual information)

Look at the pictures of these animals. Listen to the descriptions of the animals and match the right picture to each description by writing the number in the box. Share your answers with your teacher.



Pronunciation

(revision: consonant sounds in pin—big and tap—dog with familiar vowel sounds)

Remember the sounds you practised. Say these words aloud and revise the sounds.



put book tip deep peak bit took wood



Speaking

(expressing hope)

In this story, Father Wolf and Mother Wolf may have had a conversation that runs like this.

I hope I am able to protect the Man-cub from the dangers in the forest.



I do hope the Wolf Pack agrees to let us keep Mowgli with us.



I hope the same too. Let us discuss this with our friends. I have great hopes that our dream will come true.

I hope to raise him as my own cub.

Work in pairs and role play the conversation between Father Wolf and Mother Wolf.



Writing

(writing a story based on pictures and hints)

Look at these pictures and read the hints on the next page to write the story.



dog finds bun—wants to eat it alone



goes to top of bridge—sees his reflection



wants that bun too—barks greedily



the bun falls into water—greedy dog goes away sadly



Remember the following points.

- Begin the story as interestingly as possible. Try to grab the reader's attention.
- Use the correct tense of the verbs in the story.
- Use adjectives wherever possible. They make your story more appealing to the reader.
- If the story has a moral, write it at the end.
- Give an appropriate title to the story.



Life Skills Activity

(problem-solving; coping with emotions)

Look at this situation.

Mohit's baby sister often annoys him. She does not let him play with his friends. She constantly interrupts him when he speaks to his mother. She is too young to understand why he is annoyed. What should Mohit do?



Discuss your answers in class.

